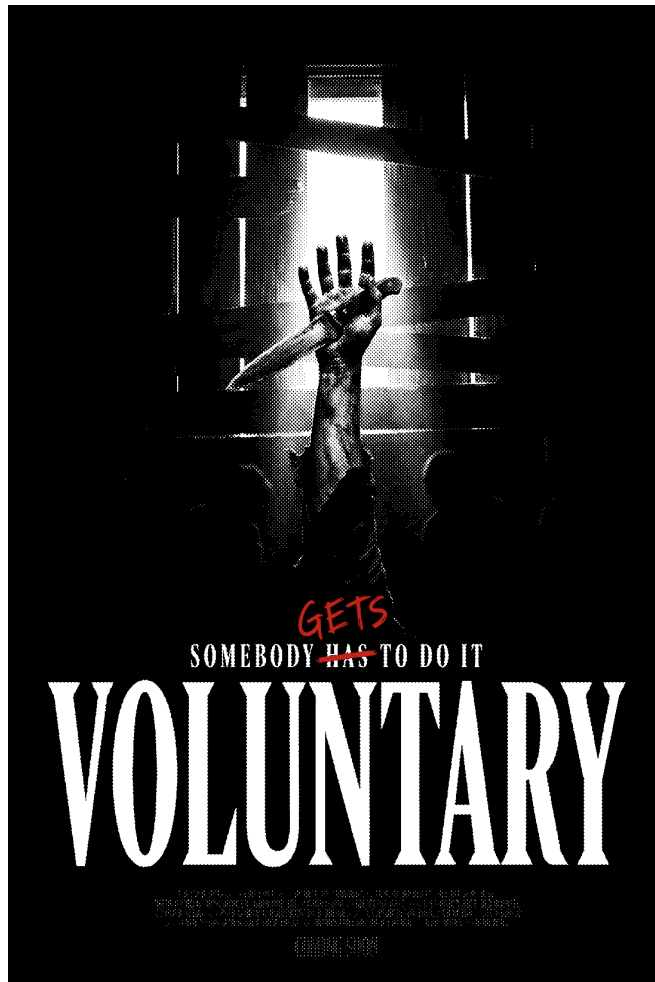




VOLUNTARY: THE BITS

Four verticals. Approx. 45 to 50 sec each.

Three verticals

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THREE STANDALONE VERTICALS. Same world, same cast, same day as the main sketch.

Shoot everything 9:16 safe. Keep whoever is talking stacked or centred rather than spread across a wide two-shot, or the crop eats somebody's reaction.

TERRY - the Volunteer. Josh.

DEAN - the Bitten.

CRISTIAN - missing teeth.

NYLA - the nurse.

CATHY - "Wrathy Cathy."

One shoots inside the main sketch, one is the kitchen, two are exterior.

EXTRA TEETH

50 seconds. Living room, inside the main sketch's setup. Shoots as part of that day, cuts out as its own thing.

INT. BOARDED-UP LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

DEAN tied to a hard chair, rope across his chest, sweating.
TERRY standing over him with a knife, close enough that this is clearly about to happen. NYLA, CATHY and CRISTIAN watching, wrecked.

Nobody has to explain any of this.

CRISTIAN

Hey.

Everyone turns. CRISTIAN has his hand in the air. He has a question.

TERRY points the knife at him.

TERRY

Yes, Cristian.

CRISTIAN

May I put in a request.

CATHY looks around the room to see whether anyone else is registering what is happening.

TERRY

Shoot.

CRISTIAN

Can I have your teeth?

Beat.

TERRY

I'm not the one dying, Cristian.

CRISTIAN

I know. I'm asking for later.

NYLA
Cristian, that is not how teeth
work. You can't just put someone's
teeth in.

CRISTIAN
I KNOW that's not how teeth work.

NYLA
Then --

CRISTIAN
That's not why I need them.

CATHY
...What do you mean "need."

CRISTIAN
(a little defensive)
Oh, don't act like you guys don't
collect stuff.

CATHY
Collect --

CRISTIAN
People find rare things
attractive. That's a normal thing
about people.

DEAN
(tied to a chair, genuinely engaged)
Wait, hold on. How did you lose
your teeth?

CRISTIAN looks at him. Completely deadpan. Completely calm.

CRISTIAN
Lose?
He pats his own back pocket.

TERRY
(hands up, peacemaking)
Okay. OKAY. Of course you can have
his teeth, that's a beautiful way
to remember somebody with such a
big f---ing mouth.

He turns back to DEAN with the knife.

He turns back to DEAN with the knife, as though something has
been settled.

CUT TO BLACK.

THE ROOM TAKES THE QUESTION SERIOUSLY. Nobody tells Cristian to shut
up. A man raises his hand during a murder and everybody stops and
hears him out, and that is the joke. Play it like a meeting.

CRISTIAN IS NOT DOING A BIT. He genuinely needs the teeth and he is
genuinely a little offended at being questioned about it.

THE POCKET PAT IS THE PUNCHLINE. He says "Lose?" and pats his back

pocket and that is all. Do not add a line on top of it. Hold on the room instead.

CATHY IS THE AUDIENCE. Her scanning the room to see if anyone else is hearing this is the release valve. Keep her in frame during the request.

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DON'T TOUCH ME

45 seconds. Exterior, night. The smallest unit in the package: one actress and one operator. We never see the zombie. Not once.

EXT. RESIDENTIAL STREET - NIGHT

BLACK. Then movement.

ZOMBIE POV. Handheld, low, lurching, fast. Wet ragged breathing right on the mic, hungry and close. Parked cars strobe past. Asphalt. Ahead of us, CATHY, running. She glances back and runs harder. We are gaining.

INTERCUT with CATHY, tight on her face as she runs. Shot selfie-rig on the Pocket 3 so it stays locked on her while she moves.

Play it straight and play it LONG. Ten seconds minimum before anything turns. The audience should be tense, not amused.

She stumbles off a curb. Recovers. We close the gap. We are right on her.

She whips around.

EXTREME CLOSE ON CATHY. Her face fills the frame. And she does not scream in fear.

CATHY
DON'T TOUCH ME.

ALT: "GET AWAY FROM ME." Shoot both.

The camera stops dead.

Two hands come up into the bottom of frame. Filthy, torn, unmistakably his. Palms out. Whoa.

The breathing changes. It goes thin and high and frightened, a wheeze pulling in and out, nothing like the sound it was making ten seconds ago.

The camera BOLTS backward. A hard whip pan as he turns, and then the street is coming at us fast the other way. He is running.

And he keeps whipping back to look. Each time, CATHY is standing exactly where she was, smaller. Watching him go.

Whip forward. Wheezing. Whip back. Smaller again.

The last look is from a long way off. She has not moved.

He rounds a corner. Fence, hedge, black.

CUT TO BLACK.

WE NEVER SEE HIM. The entire piece is his point of view. The only part of him that ever enters frame is the two hands going up, and they are on screen for under a second. No makeup beyond dirty hands.

No second performer in shot. One actress, one operator.

HE IS TERRIFIED. Flat out, one hundred percent scared of her. Not caught out, not sheepish. The bolt is panic and the looks back are him checking she is not following.

That is the whole joke: a zombie is scared of a woman's wrath exactly like any guy at a bar is.

THE BREATHING IS THE PERFORMANCE. It is the only acting he gets to do. Hungry and wet on the way in, thin and wheezing and scared on the way out. Record it separately and clean, close on the mic, so it can be laid in properly.

CATHY plays it real. Full wrath, straight down the lens, and she means every word. Not shrill. Furious.

COVERAGE

- POV chase handheld, 20 seconds, doubles as trailer pickup 1
- Cathy running, Pocket 3 selfie rig, a few passes
- Cathy's close-up, many takes. Let her go bigger than feels right, then get one flat and bored. The bored one may be the funniest and you will not know until the edit.
- Both line readings
- The hands going up, a few takes, they only need one good second
- The retreat: run the street the other way with three or four whip-pans back to her
- Cathy holding her ground at increasing distances, so the looks back have something to cut to
- Breathing recorded clean and separate, both states

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PREP

50 seconds. Kitchen, same house, same day. The one that makes the main sketch funnier in hindsight.

INT. KITCHEN - DAY

NYLA at the sink, back to the door, rinsing a turnip under a thin trickle. A pot on a camp stove. Carrots and a slab of pork belly waiting on the board.

And in the doorway behind her, close, already there, TERRY. Leaning on the frame. Smiling.

TERRY

Need some help?

She jumps out of her skin.

NYLA

Oh my God. You scared me.

(beat)

No, actually, yes. You want to prep the ingredients for the stew?

TERRY

Would I ever.

He has the cleaver before she has finished turning around.

TERRY (CONT'D)

So what's on your mind. You've been quiet all day.

NYLA

...Nobody says thank you.

TERRY

Mm.

Which sounds like listening. She takes it as listening.

NYLA (CONT'D)

Not once. I have stitched up every person in this house and not one of you has ever asked how I'm doing. You just did. You're the first person who's asked me anything in a week.

He lines up a carrot. Takes his time with it. The cleaver knocks the board.

TERRY

Mm.

That one did not come after anything she said.

NYLA (CONT'D)
I keep thinking about my sister's
wedding. I was so annoyed I had to
go. I sat in the car drafting a
text to get out of it.

Knock. A small exhale.

TERRY
Mmm.

She stops. Looks at him. Keeps going, slower.

NYLA (CONT'D)
That's the last time I saw her.

TERRY moves to the pork belly. Sets it square. Adjusts his
grip. Brings the cleaver down through it in one pass. And for
just a second, he closes his eyes.

TERRY (CONT'D)
Mmmm.
And she has it.

NYLA (CONT'D)
Terry.

TERRY
Hm.

NYLA
Did you hear any of that.

TERRY
...Yeah.

He did not. She looks at the cleaver, then at his face, then
back at the cleaver, and she cannot name what she is seeing.
Then he is done, and he looks at the empty board, and he is
genuinely disappointed.

TERRY (CONT'D)
...Anything else need cutting?

NYLA
No.

A beat.

TERRY
Okay.

He does not move. He does not put the cleaver down.

CUT TO BLACK.

THE MMs ARE THE REVEAL. The first one lands right after her line and
reads as listening, and she takes it that way. Every one after lands
right after a CUT instead, and each is a little longer. She works
out what they actually are in real time, and so does the audience.
Do not play them as sexual. Play them as genuinely satisfied. The
horror is that he means them.

THE MONOLOGUE IS A SUGGESTION. Whoever plays Nyla should bring her

own if she has one. It only has to be two things: ordinary enough that anyone watching has felt it, and real enough that ignoring it is a crime. The specifics do not matter, the fact that he asked for it and then checked out does.

HE ASKS HER. That is the engine. He invites her to open up and then does not hear a word of it, which is worse than being distracted.

HIS EYES CLOSE ON HER WORST LINE. Time it so the good cut lands on the most vulnerable thing she says. That is the peak.

CUT BACK AND FORTH between her face and the board. Her doing real emotional work, his hands doing something else entirely, getting further apart as it goes.

PLAY THE DOORWAY AS A REAL SCARE. Sting it, hold the silence, shoot it like something is standing behind her. Then it is just a guy asking a polite question.

RESTRAINT IS THE JOKE. Explicit kills it. A small exhale, a half second of closed eyes, a delayed "hm".

FOR THE TRAILER: a clean wide of Terry calmly working the board with no performance in it at all. Only funny in hindsight.

THE LOUD ONE

45 seconds. Exterior, night. The one that proves Terry is telling the truth in the main sketch.

EXT. RESIDENTIAL STREET - NIGHT

All five crouched behind a parked car, packed tight against the door panels, dead still. CRISTIAN, NYLA and CATHY are up at the front bumper, backs to us, watching something around the corner, and they stay that way the whole scene. TERRY and DEAN are low by the rear wheel, where TERRY leans in and whispers. Barely air.

TERRY
Is it still out there?

DEAN
Shh.

TERRY
(whisper)
I'm whispering.

DEAN
(louder than Terry)
Shhhh.

TERRY
That's louder than me.

NYLA
(not turning around)
Both of you.

TERRY
She means you.

DEAN
Shhhhh.

TERRY lets it go. Genuinely. Three seconds of silence, and DEAN waits out every one of them before he leans into Terry's ear.

DEAN (CONT'D)
Shh.

TERRY
Dude. You need to STOP.

Full volume, carrying down the whole block. Every head at the bumper snaps around.

CATHY
SHHH!

NYLA
Are you stupid?!

TERRY
IT'S HIS FAULT!

CRISTIAN
Man, shut UP.

The car they are hiding behind ERUPTS. Headlights, horn, full alarm. Every head turns to TERRY.

DEAN, crouched in the middle of a group glaring at Terry, turns to TERRY alone. Wide eyes, eyebrows up, delighted. They scatter.

CUT TO BLACK.

CRAFT

Terry has to be unimpeachably innocent for the first half or the bait does not read and it is just two guys being annoying. Let the audience get ahead of the group.

Dean plays sincere concern the whole way. No smirk, no wink, until the final look, and the delight is only for Terry, never for camera.

Lavs on Terry and Dean. The whole bit is a volume joke, so the gap between his whisper and Dean's shush has to survive the mix. Alarm goes in during post.

Shoot Dean's final look long. That is the shot.

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